



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

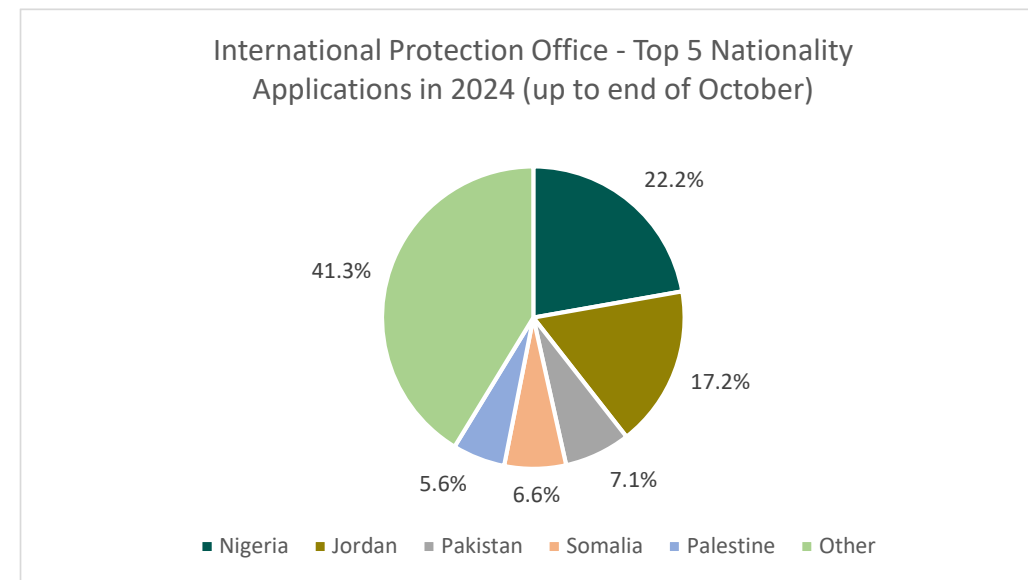
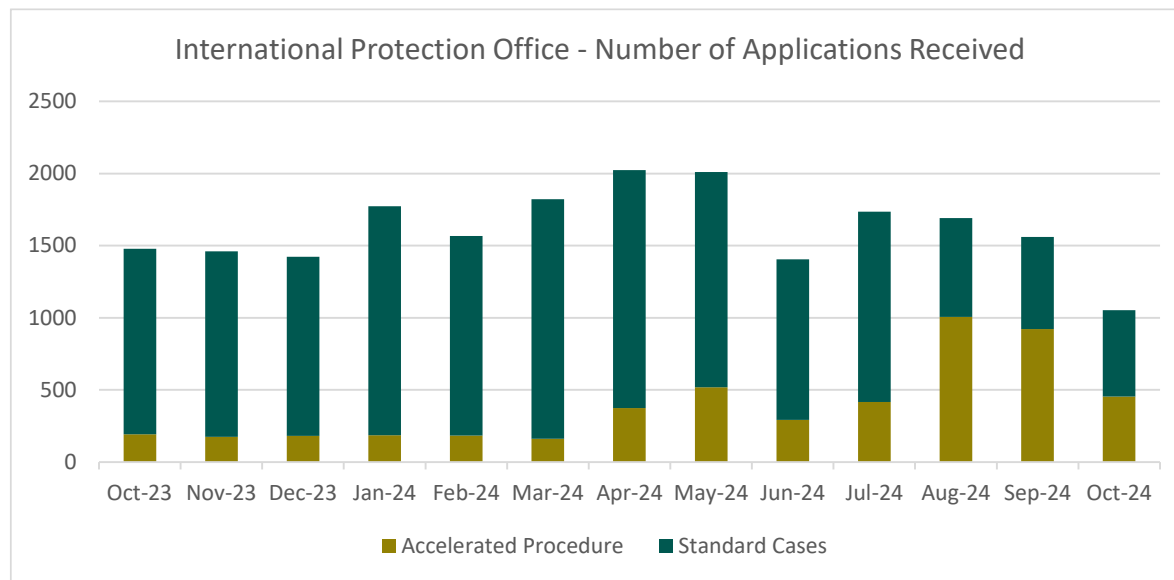
International Protection: October 2024

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 06th November 2024. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for October 2024:

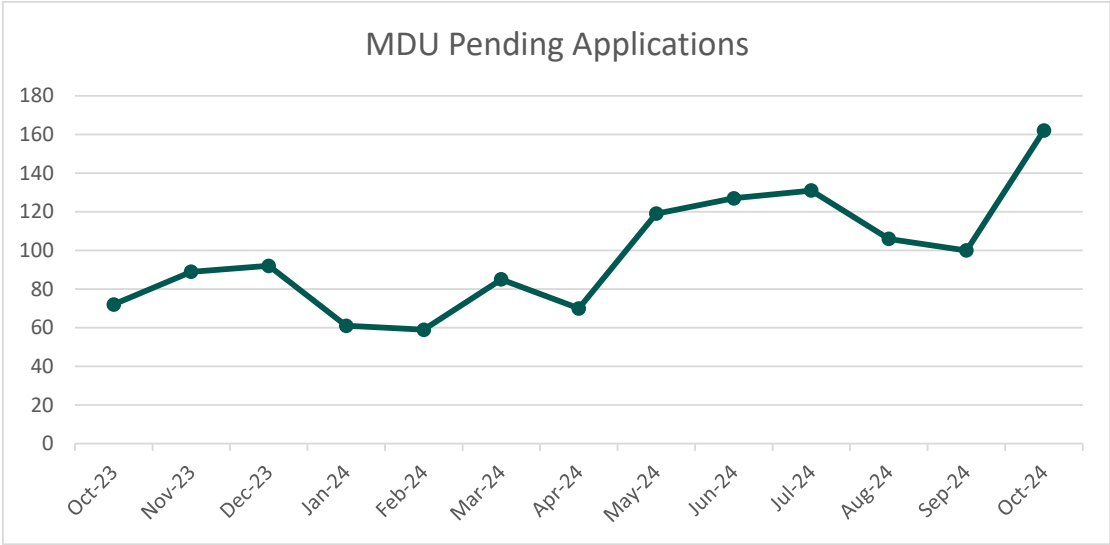
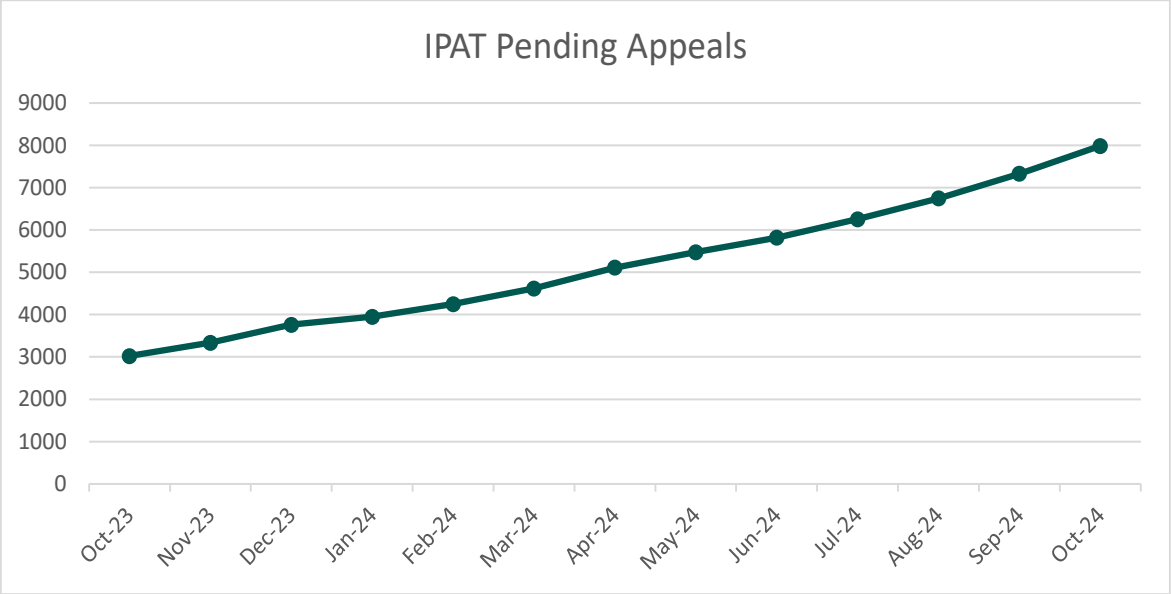
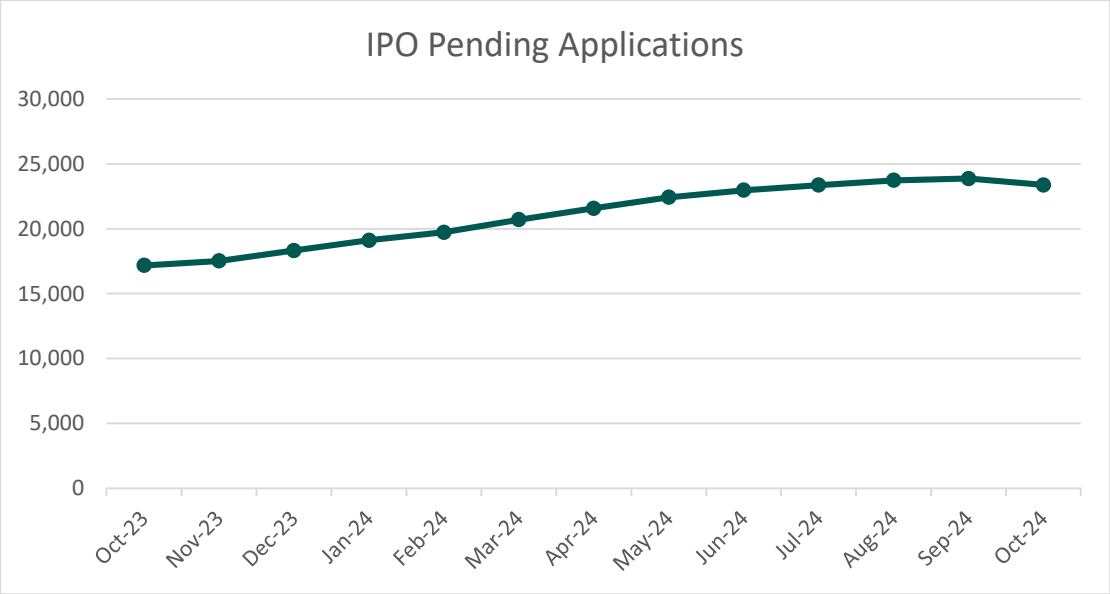
- The number of asylum applications is trending down. In October there were 1,053 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,479 last October
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (3,696 applications), Jordan (2,865), Pakistan (1,176), Somalia (1,096) and Palestine (935)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO have been levelling out since July 2024. As of October this year there were 23,373 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has increased in October 2024 where 1,510 cases were closed off
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has begun to trend slowly upwards again, after having shown a downward trend between May 2024 and August 2024. In October 2024 the median processing time to determination was 85 weeks (compared to 79 weeks in July 2024 and 82 in April 2024)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 557 at the end of October 2024
- Of those applications where a decision was made in October by MDU, 40% of decisions were refusals, 3.5% permission to remain, and 56.5% were international protection grants

Applications and main nationalities



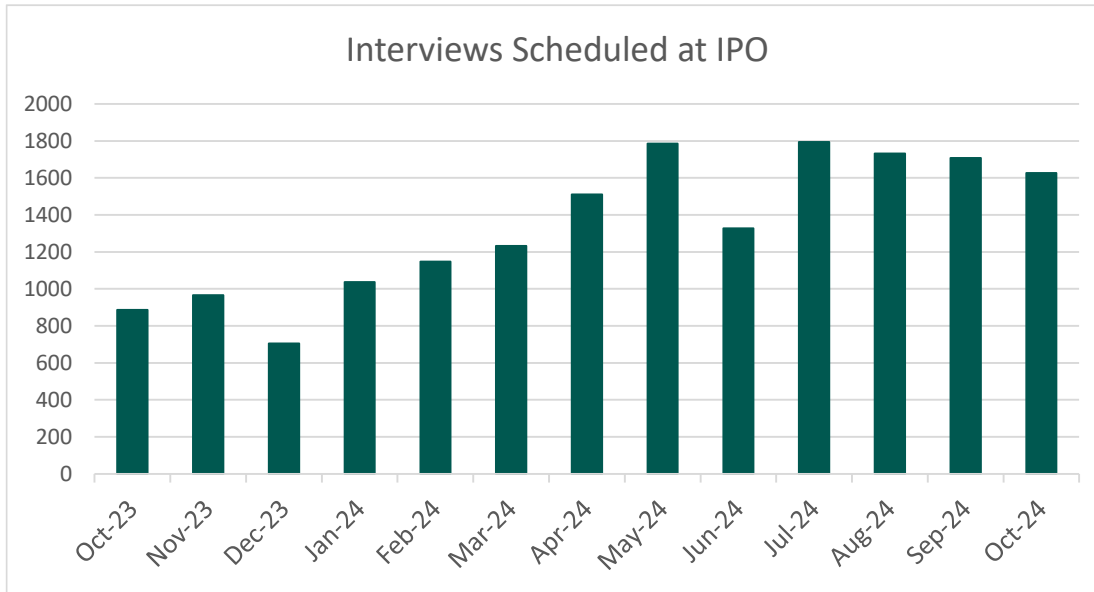
- In October there were 1,053 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,479 last October. The average number of applications per month between November 2023 and October 2024 was 1,627
- For October 2024, the total number of applications included 453 from accelerated procedure (43% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (3,696 applications), Jordan (2,865), Pakistan (1,176), Somalia (1,096) and Palestine (935)

Pending International Protection Applications

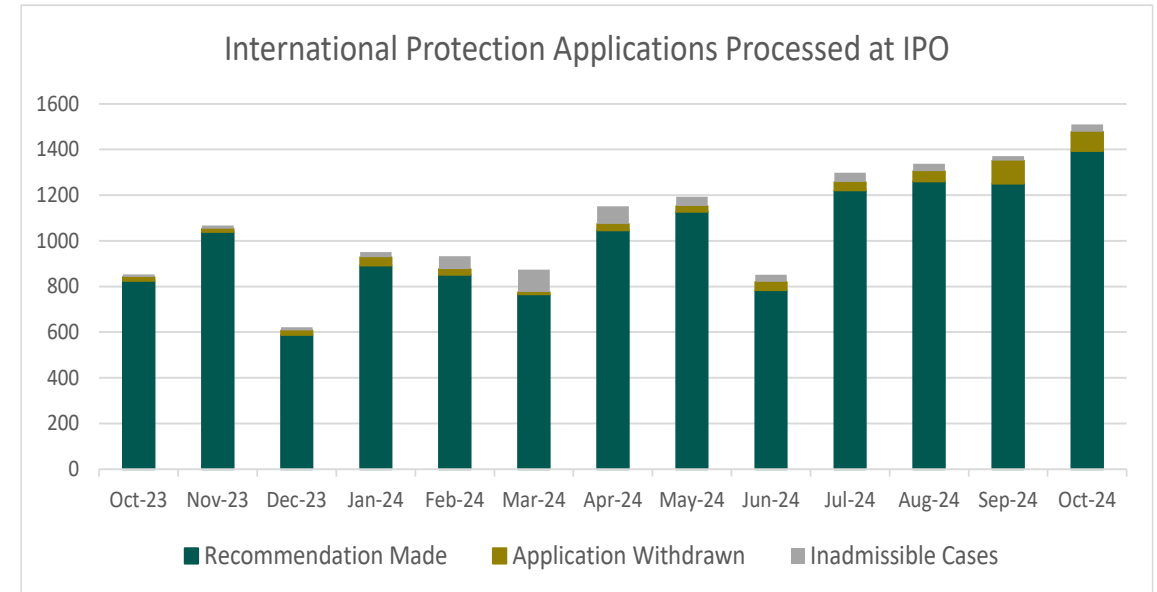


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 23,373. The numbers have been levelling out since July 2023 (23,360 cases pending)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards since October 2023. In October 2024, there were 7,990 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of October 2024 is 162

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

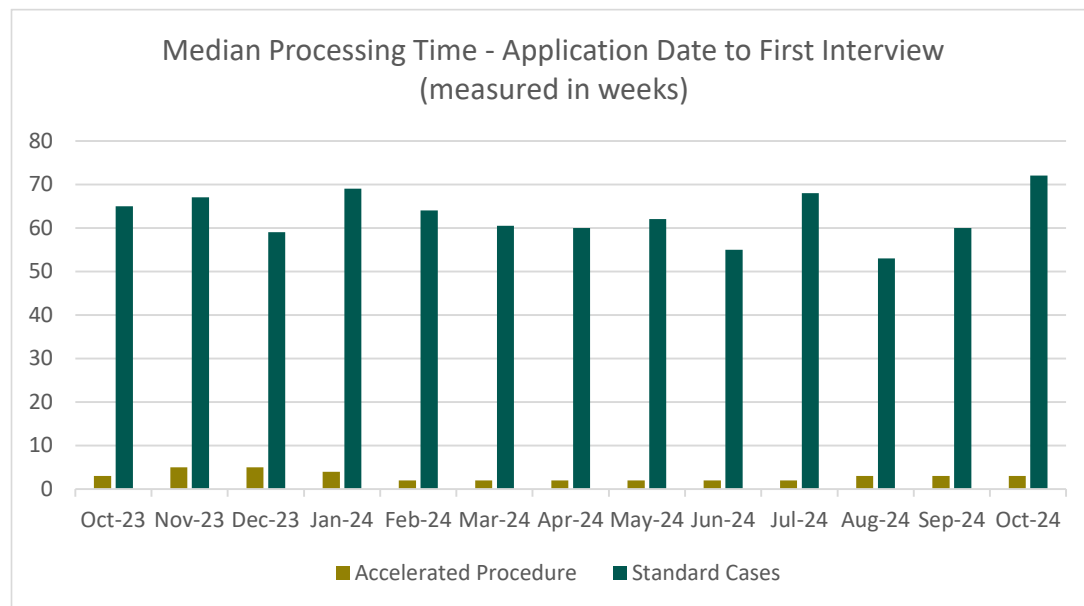


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO has been trending down since July 2024
- In October 2024, there were 1,627 interviews scheduled, down from 1,708 in September and down from 1,732 in August
- 2024 YTD interviews scheduled were 14,904 (an 84.5% increase on 8,077 interviews scheduled for 2023 YTD)

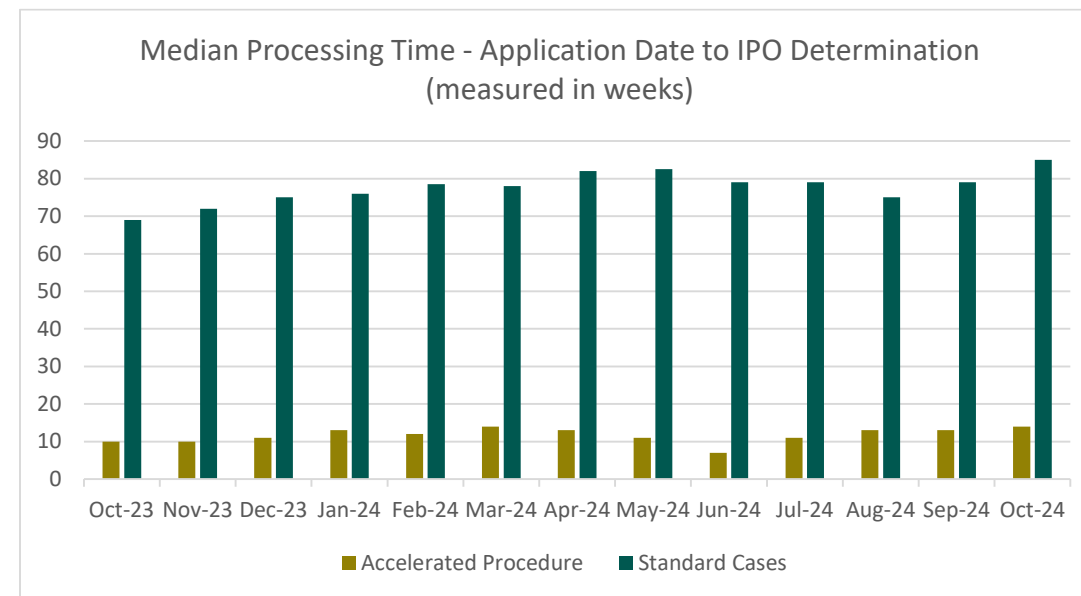


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In October 2024, 1,510 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,371 in September and 1,337 in August
- 2024 YTD applications processed were 11,469 (a 59% increase on 7,197 applications processed for 2023 YTD)

International Protection Applications Processing Times

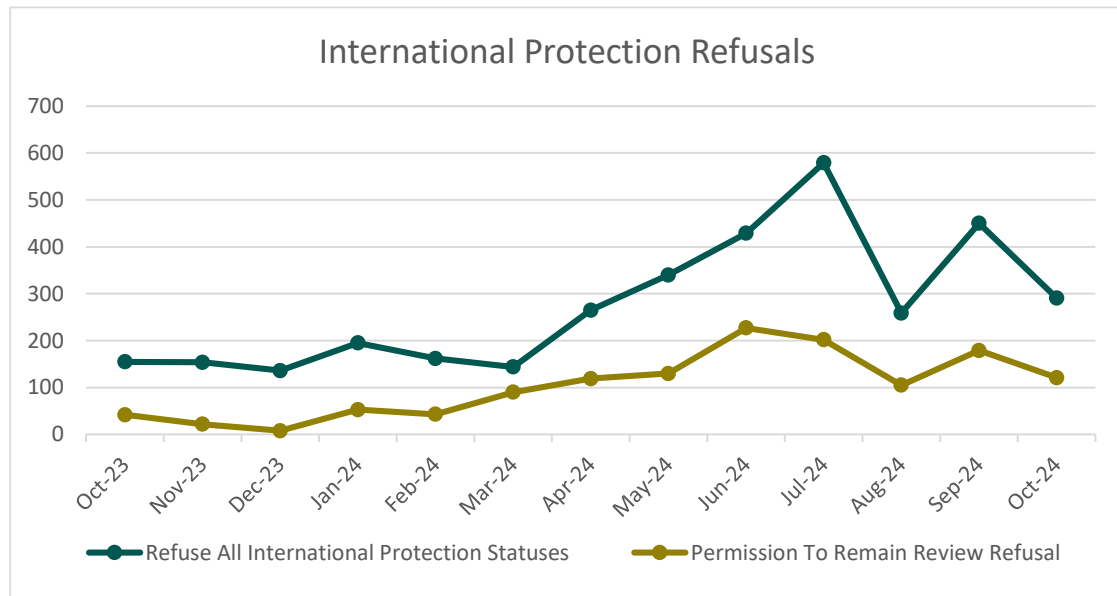
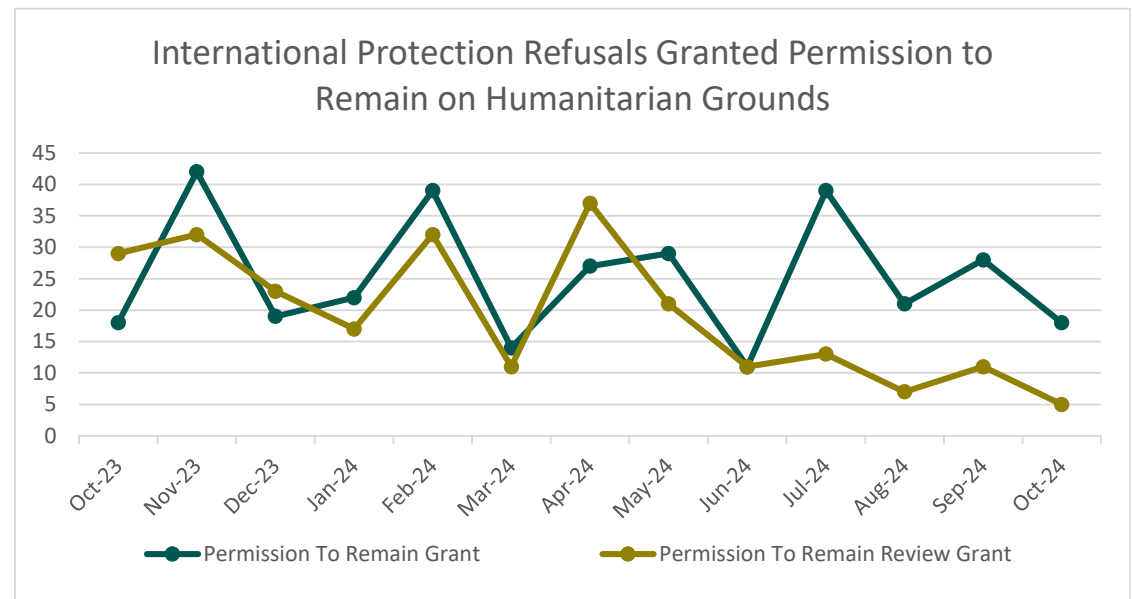
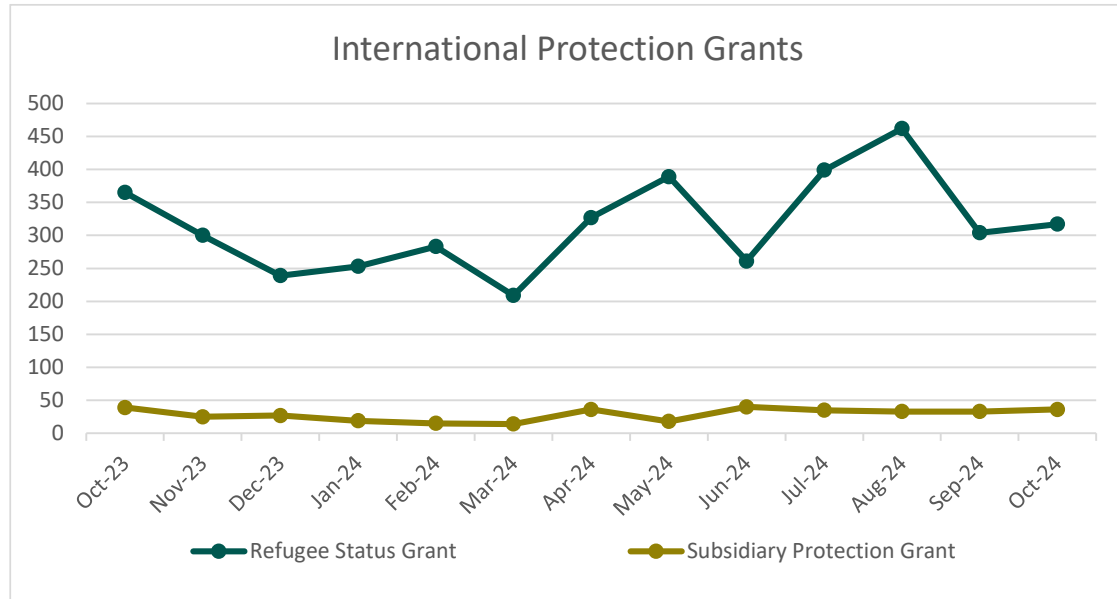


- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview is trending upwards. In October 2024, it was 72 weeks for standard cases, up from 60 weeks in September and up from 53 weeks in August
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for October was 3 weeks, the same as August and September 2024



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly increasing since August 2024
- In October 2024, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 85 weeks (up from 79 weeks in September and up from 75 weeks for August)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 14 weeks in October, up from 13 weeks for September and up from 13 weeks in August

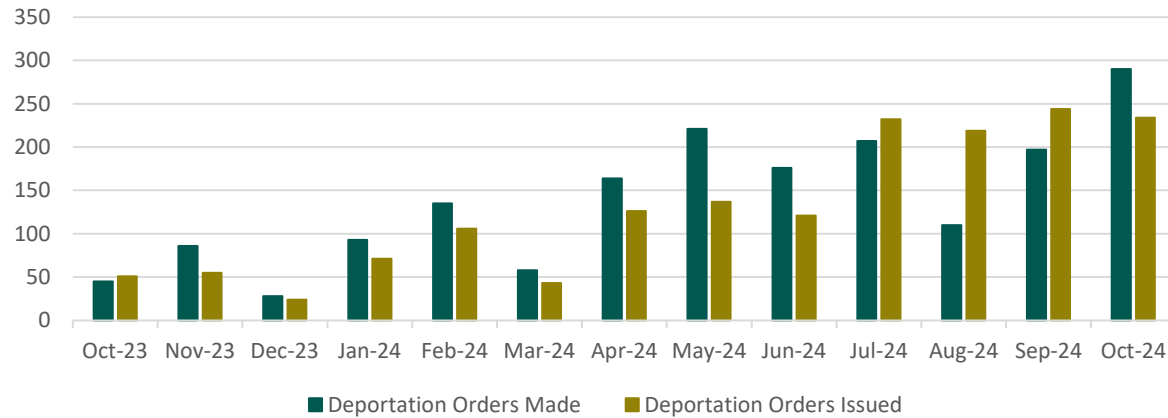
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In October, of those applications where a decision was made, 317 were given refugee status grant and 36 subsidiary protection grant (353 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 18 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 5 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 291 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 121 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for October, 40% of decisions were refusals, 3.5% permission to remain, and 56.5% were international protection grants

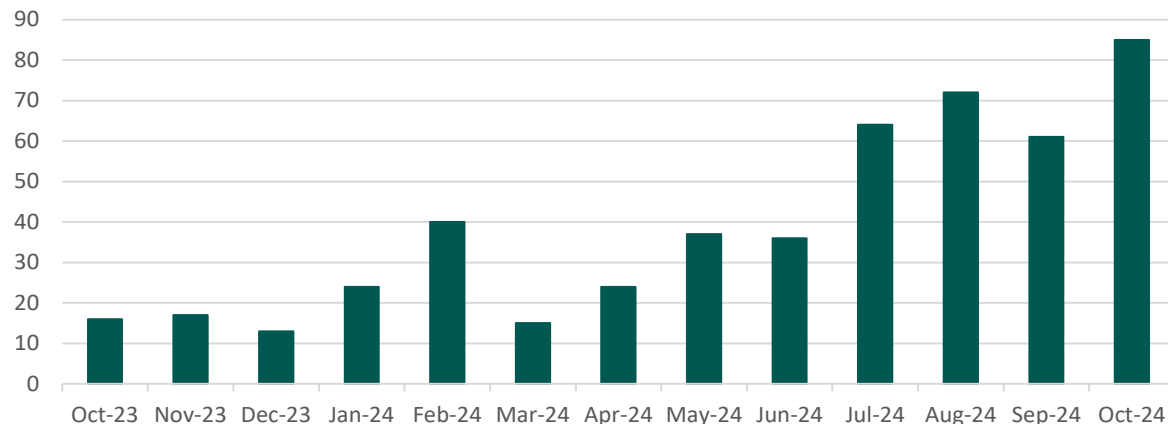
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

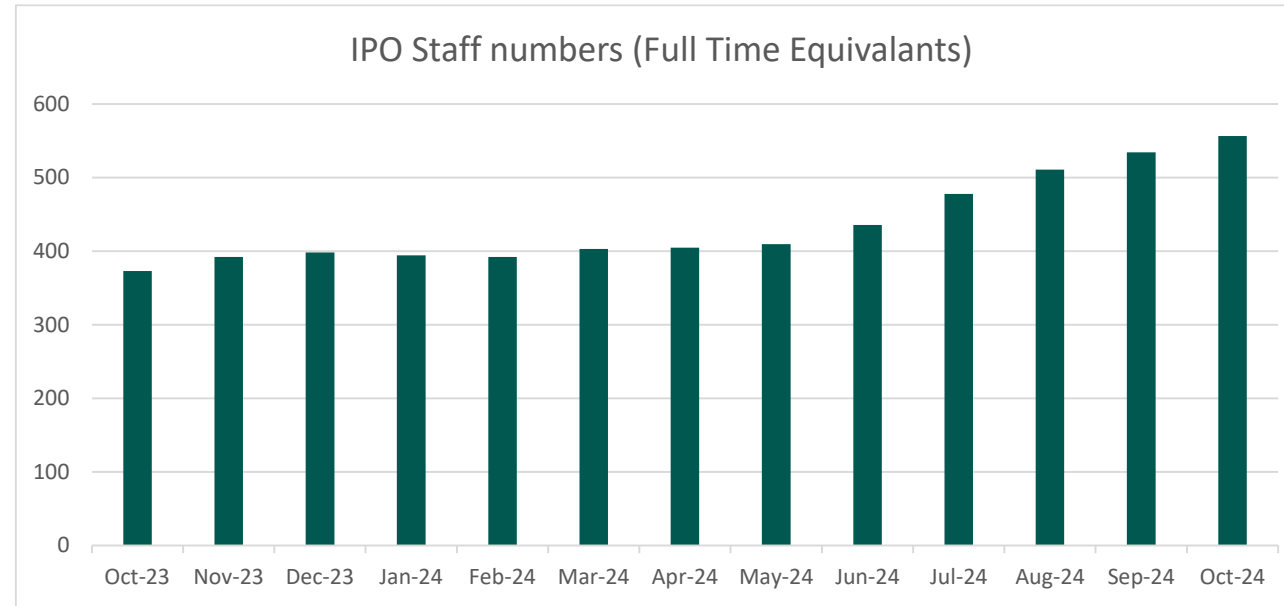


- For October 2024 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 290 and the number of deportation orders issued was 234. For September, the figures were 197 and 244 and for August it was 110 and 219, respectively
- For October 2024 the number of removals was 85

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing.
- In October 2023 there were 373 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 405 in April 2024 and 478 in July 2024.
- At the end of October 2024, the IPO had 557 FTE staff.



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

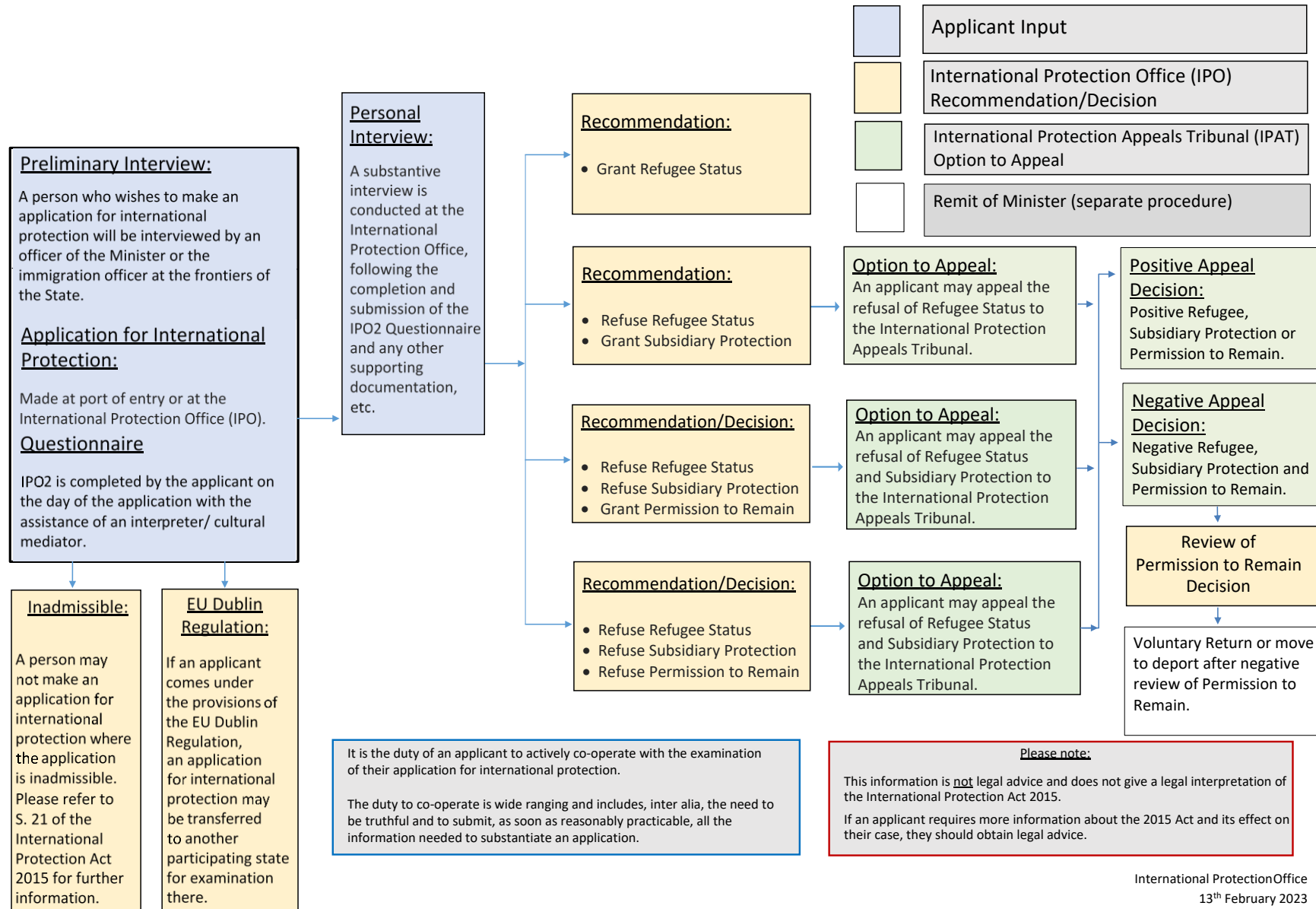
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Accelerated Procedure	193	175	182	186	183	162	374	519	292	417	1006	922	453
Standard Cases	1286	1286	1241	1588	1384	1659	1649	1492	1113	1318	686	638	600

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2024 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	3696	22.2%
Jordan	2865	17.2%
Pakistan	1176	7.1%
Somalia	1096	6.6%
Palestine	935	5.6%
Other	6867	41.3%
Total	16635	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

IPO Pending	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
IP Pending	17,171	17,524	18,314	19,109	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863	23,373

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
IPAT Pending	3020	3337	3762	3949	4251	4620	5110	5478	5821	6257	6748	7331	7990

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
MDU Pending	72	89	92	61	59	85	70	119	127	131	106	100	162

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Interviews Scheduled	887	966	705	1037	1148	1233	1511	1786	1328	1794	1732	1708	1627

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Recommendation Made	825	1039	588	892	851	766	1046	1128	784	1221	1261	1250	1394
Application Withdrawn	16	14	19	37	25	10	28	25	36	36	44	101	83
Inadmissible Cases	12	14	15	22	57	98	77	40	31	41	32	20	33

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Accelerated Procedure	3	5	5	4	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	3
Standard Cases	65	67	59	69	64	60.5	60	62	55	68	53	60	72

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Accelerated Procedure	10	10	11	13	12	14	13	11	7	11	13	13	14
Standard Cases	69	72	75	76	78.5	78	82	82.5	79	79	75	79	85

Data Tables (5)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Refugee Status Grant	365	300	239	253	283	209	327	389	261	399	462	304	317
Subsidiary Protection Grant	39	25	27	19	15	14	36	18	40	35	33	33	36
Permission to Remain Grant	18	42	19	22	39	14	27	29	11	39	21	28	18
Permisssion to Remain Review Grant	29	32	23	17	32	11	37	21	11	13	7	11	5

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	155	154	136	195	162	144	265	340	429	579	259	450	291
Permission to Remain Review Refusal	42	22	8	53	43	90	119	130	227	202	105	179	121

Data Tables (6)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Deportation Orders Made	45	86	28	93	135	58	164	221	176	207	110	197	290
Deportation Orders Issued	51	55	24	71	106	43	126	137	121	232	219	244	234

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
Enforcements/Returns	16	17	13	24	40	15	24	37	36	64	72	61	85

Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24
IPO Staffing Level	373.1	392.1	398.1	394.1	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3